

Sony Cyber-shot DSC-S2100

Features

- Resolution: 12.1 MP
- Optical zoom: 3x
- LCD: 7.6 cm (3 inches)

Price
₹ 7990



or go online to read the user/expert feedback on your zeroed-in product. If everything seems fine, go ahead and make the purchase.

You can go about the various features and functions as below:

Choice between DSLR and point-and-shoot. "High-end and medium-range DSLR cameras are best for still pictures and are especially meant for professionals who have in-depth knowledge of photography. For general-users, point-and-shoot cameras are more preferable," recommends Kenichi Tanaka, managing director, FUJIFILM India.

Once you are comfortable with composition and light conditions, you can graduate to a DSLR with more features and accessories. You can even go for a film-based DSLR, which is another level.

Megapixels. More pixels mean more details, i.e., greater smoothness in the

picture. However, megapixels alone will not decide the quality of the image captured. How does the camera process the digital image and the optics used are utmost important. That's why picture quality varies from brand to brand.

For a professional more megapixels mean greater print size, whereas for a regular user this is not a major factor in deciding the camera. (Higher-MP pictures require much higher storage space.) Today, you get 10-14 MP, which is good enough.

Zoom. A D-SLR has the advantage of interchangeable lenses. Therefore you can choose what suits you better. Normally, focal length starting from 18 mm to 100 mm is more than sufficient. For compact camera users, a higher zoom is better. However, zoom above 20x should be handled carefully as at this zoom level images will tend

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Do's and don'ts for first-time buyers

Do's

- Always do some research work before you buy either a digital still camera or a camcorder.
- Decide what is more important, shooting good-quality video or good-quality stills?
- Always try out the product you want to purchase. Handling, features and even looks are often important factors.
- Read the manual carefully before using the product. Often you might not get satisfactory results just because you are not using the camera properly. In case of any doubt, ask for a demo from the retailer.
- Take proper care of your digital equipment. Use the necessary precautions, and always use proper recommended accessories.

Don'ts

- Do not purchase from unauthorised dealers. You may experience malfunctions, and in some cases, the manufacturer may not be able to provide technical assistance.
- Do not use accessories that are not recommended with your product.
- In case of service requirements, always go to authorised operators.
- Do not disassemble the camera. This might cause shock hazards, or severe damage to the camera. Read the safety recommendations provided in your manual.
- Do not let small children handle the camera without supervision.
- Do not violate safety regulations while shooting.

—Hiroshi Takashina, managing director, Nikon India

to shake and you need to use tripod. Normally, 10x is more than sufficient.

Optical zoom makes sense for multiple applications of the camera—recording birthday celebrations, outdoor video, etc. All cameras come with minimum of 3x optical zoom.

Image stabilisation. Whichever camera you decide, make sure it has optical image stabilisation. Optical image stabilisation helps to prevent blurred